Making qualitative data reusable

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DCC Spring Training Days 2025

24 June 2025

Slides available on Zenodo:
https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15696286

Welcome

Programme

09:30 - 10:00 Welcome & Introduction Round

10:00 - 10:45 Data Publishing & Access Restrictions

10:45 - 11:00 Break

11:00 - 11:30 Data Processing & Tools

11:30 - 12:00 Project Planning & Informed Consent

12:00 - 12:30 Q&A & Wrap up

DANS

Dutch national centre of expertise & repository for research data

Offers **data publishing and archiving services** for individual researchers and institutes

Offers **advice** and **training** on Research Data Management (**RDM**), **FAIR data** and **Open Science**

Consortium of European Social Science Data Archives

CESSDA provides large-scale, integrated and sustainable data services to the social sciences community, including

- A Data Discovery Portal
- Data Management Training
- Controlled Vocabulary Services

DANS is the Service Provider for the Netherlands

https://www.cessda.eu/

Introduction Round

What is qualitative data?

Qualitative data refers to information that is not gathered in numerical form, but rather describes qualities or characteristics.

- Natural language
- Textual
- Visual

Photography | audio recordings | video |
Interviews | diary accounts | unstructured observations

Image CC-BY-SA from CESSDA Training Team (2017 - 2022). *CESSDA Data Management Expert Guide.* Bergen, Norway: CESSDA ERIC. Retrieved from https://dmeg.cessda.eu/

Making qualitative data reusable - Report

https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8160880

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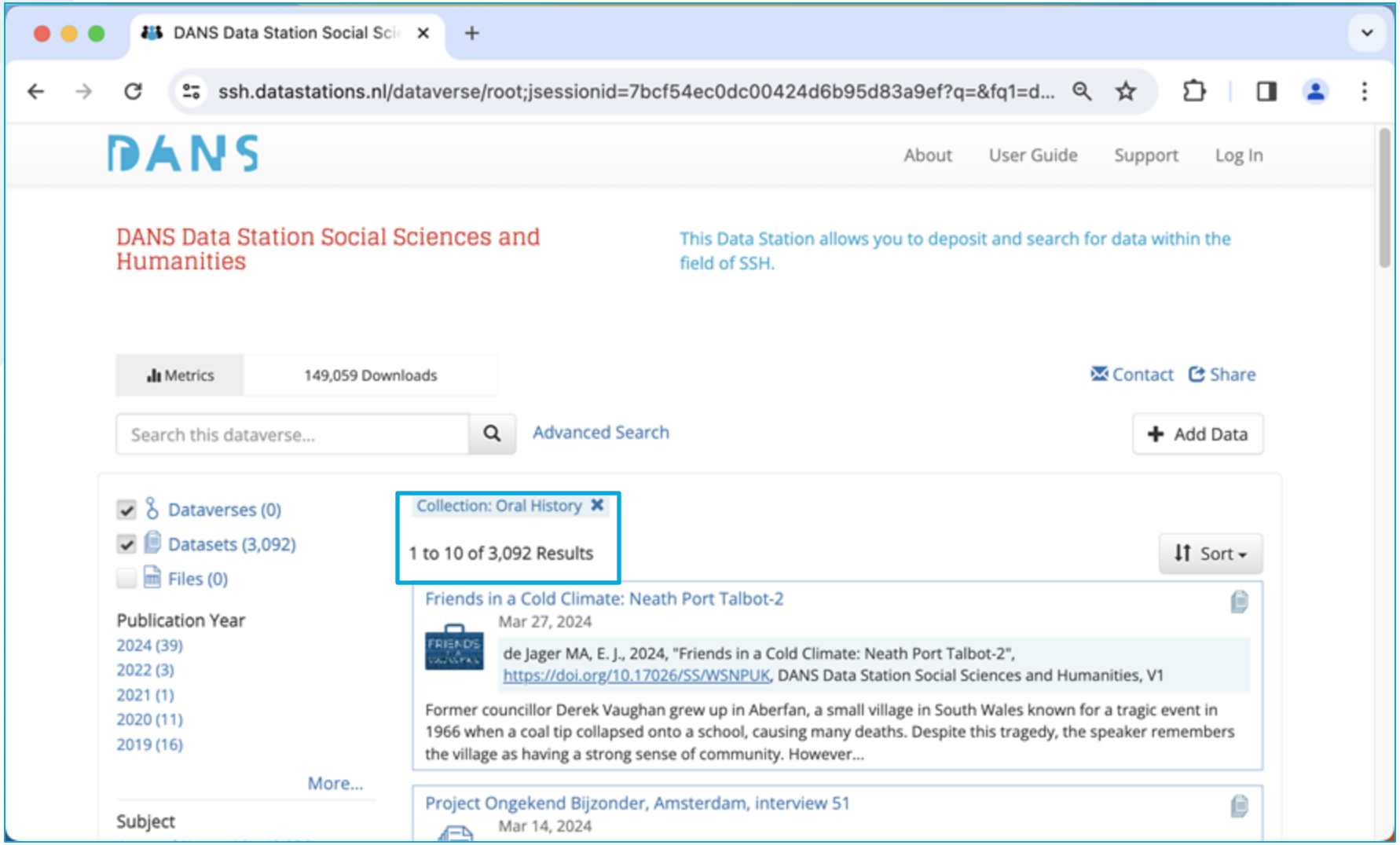
Note: We are currently working on a revised version which will be published after the summer!

Making Qualitative Data Reusable

Qualitative Data Published in the DANS Data Station SSH



Starting at the goal

Taking a published dataset: What is needed to get to this?

Consider this example dataset:

- Interview data
- Personal data (not special category, topic is not sensitive, disclosure would bring no harm to the participant)
- Published in the Data Station SSH
  - Open: De-identified transcript, documentation
  - Restricted: Audio recording of the interview

Starting at the goal

Datasets comparable to this example in our Data Station

Stigter, Sanneke; Hatem, Amr; Mavroudis, Orestis, 2024, "Interview: My Bundgaard on Robert Rauschenberg's Mud Muse", https://doi.org/10.17026/SS/8RLLMN, DANS Data Station Social Sciences and Humanities, V1

A.S. Soulioti; M.D. Ducimetière; R.K. Kievits, 2020, "Interview Flavio Pons on Grenzeloze Inhoud", https://doi.org/10.17026/dans-zfs-ezwu, DANS Data Station Social Sciences and Humanities, V3

How FAIR are the example datasets?

EXERCISE
15 min

Box 2 | The FAIR Guiding Principles

To be Findable:
F1. (meta)data are assigned a globally unique and persistent identifier
F2. data are described with rich metadata (defined by R1 below)
F3. metadata clearly and explicitly include the identifier of the data it describes
F4. (meta)data are registered or indexed in a searchable resource

To be Accessible:
A1. (meta)data are retrievable by their identifier using a standardized communications protocol
A1.1 the protocol is open, free, and universally implementable
A1.2 the protocol allows for an authentication and authorization procedure, where necessary
A2. metadata are accessible, even when the data are no longer available

To be Interoperable:
I1. (meta)data use a formal, accessible, shared, and broadly applicable language for knowledge representation.
I2. (meta)data use vocabularies that follow FAIR principles
I3. (meta)data include qualified references to other (meta)data

To be Reusable:
R1. meta(data) are richly described with a plurality of accurate and relevant attributes
R1.1. (meta)data are released with a clear and accessible data usage license
R1.2. (meta)data are associated with detailed provenance
R1.3. (meta)data meet domain-relevant community standards

Wilkinson et al 2016

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Wilkinson et al 2016

Example dataset – Steps that were taken

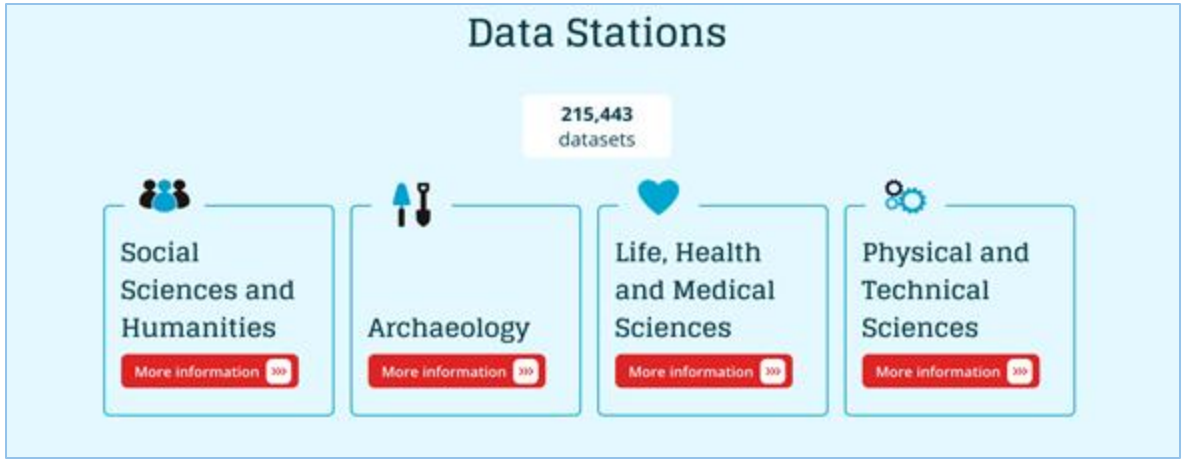
- Selecting a Trustworthy Digital Repository
  - Provides a PID for the dataset
  - Allows collection of metadata (in various formats)
  - Has data access mechanism
  - Provides support and curation
- Preparing data and documentation
  - Metadata
  - Data description
  - Access information (if needed)
- Determined the access conditions

Selecting a repository

Selection a repository - DANS Data Station

The Guide provides extra information about finding a repository (e.g. through Re3data)

- **Domain-specific** data publishing and archiving service for researchers
- Making use of Dataverse technology
- DANS manages the technical infrastructure
- DANS manages the **curation** of the data
- **Long term storage** in our Vault
- CoreTrustSeal **certified**



Preparing the dataset

Preparing the dataset

- Prepare a dataset according to the repository guidelines
  - Metadata and Documentation
  - Preferred file formats

- Balance between **open** formats and proprietary **community standards**

Open	**Proprietary community-standard**
+ long-term sustainability (migration) + accessible to all without software installation - if converted from proprietary format, information could be lost	+ generally used and understood in the community + no risk of information loss due to conversion - risk of poor long-term sustainability (no migration, software updates, obsolescence) - not/less accessible to other potential future users

- Depositing the same data in multiple formats

Preparing the dataset

Guidelines from DANS

- Preferred file formats (DANS)
- Metadata guidelines (including specific for qualitative data)
- Qualitative Data Guide

The Guide provides more example guidelines specific to qualitative data.

You need to chose the access conditions for the dataset!

Selecting the right access condition

As open as possible as closed as necessary

Following the Open Science principles you want to publish **Open Access** where possible

Consider

- Sensivity
- Copyrights and other legal obligations
- Personal Data - AVG

As open as possible as closed as necessary

Following the Open Science principles you want to publish **Open Access** where possible

Consider

- Sensivity
- Copyrights and other legal obligations
- Personal Data - AVG

Challenges particular for qualitative data

- Data which is hard to anonymise or pseudonymise!
- You lose contextual information
- Qualitative aspects are what you want to study

Publishing at DANS: Open and Restricted Access

Example dataset:

- Open: De-identified transcript, documentation
- Restricted: Audio recording of the interview

Open Access	Restricted Access
Anyone can download.	A registered user can download after the depositor has given them permission.

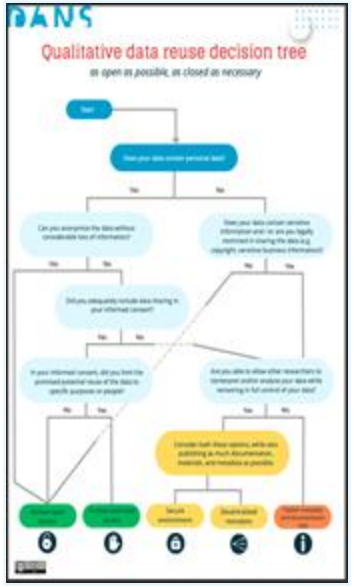
Publishing at DANS: Open and Restricted Access

How did we get there? → Decision Tree(s)

- Mitigating risks
- Complying with legal obligations
- Protection Personal Data

The Guide provides extra information about options when open and restricted access is not possible

Note: The Trees are also being updated!



https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8160890

Question

Based on the decision tree(s) which access category would you chose for the example dataset?

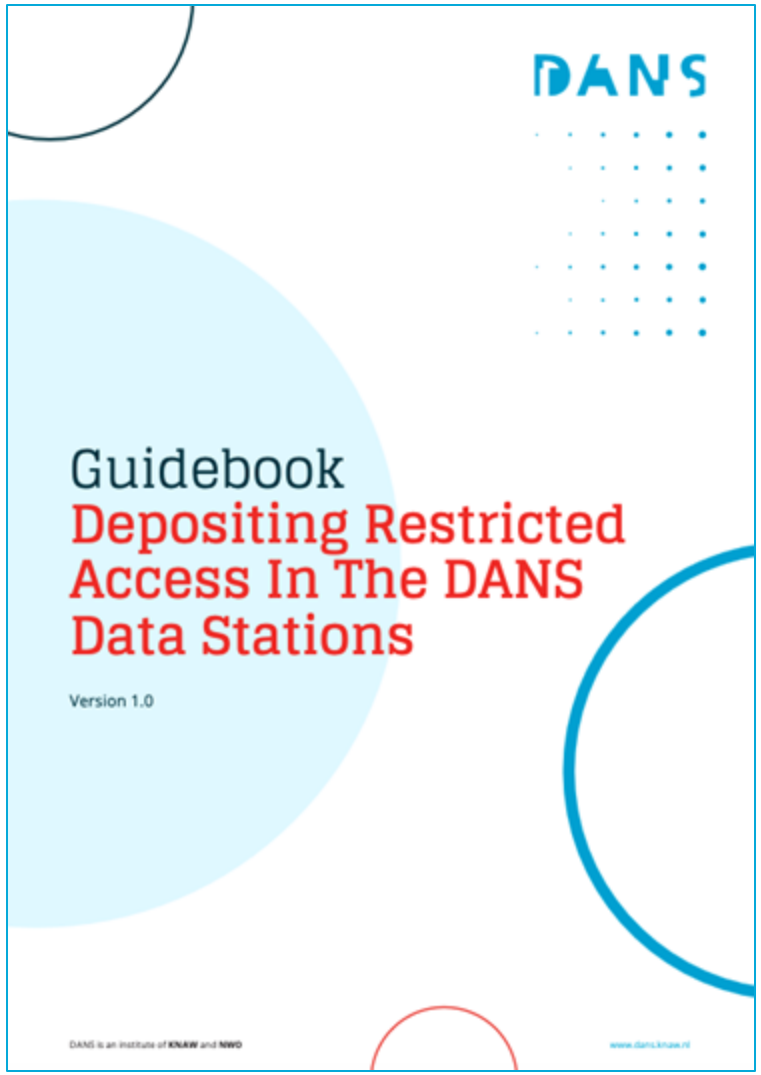
- Mitigating risks
- Complying with legal obligations
- Protection Personal Data

Example dataset:

- Open: De-identified transcript, documentation
- Restricted: Audio recording of the interview

Guidebook on Restricted Access

- Provides additional guidance
- Focus on DANS Data Station SSH
  - Access categories and licences we offer
  - Metadata fields around access information
- Does include general guidance
  - Tips on selecting the right access for your dataset
  - Tips on what information to document
  - Template for a Data Access Protocol



https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.10887484

Prepare a Data Access Protocol

- DAP template takes you through all the questions to consider when restricting access
  - Do you allow
    - use beyond research?
    - commercial use?
    - educational use?
    - use outside of Europe?
  - Do you require a motivation for reuse? How is it evaluated?
  - Who is responsible to evaluate requests? How is this organized now and in the future?

Download DAP template:
https:/doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.10887571

- Preparing this well makes it easier for you to manage access
- Researchers who want to reuse data can better evaluate if they are allowed to

- There are some examples of DAPs in our Data Station (e.g https://doi.org/10.17026/SS/LNFAXI)

DISCUSSION
10 min

Access Conditions for your data

Have a look at the Data Access Protocol

- Which aspects are difficult to fill in?
- Who do you need in order to provide all the information?
- Are there standard access procedures at your institute?
- Do you miss any information that could be relevant?

Break

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12:00 - 12:30 Q&A & Wrap up

Example dataset – Steps that were taken

- Audio files were collected
  - Check preferred formats of the repository!
- Transcript based on the audio file were made
  - Check preferred formats of the repository!
  - How is this created? Can you use open tools?
- Transcript was de-identified
  - How is this created? Can you use open tools?

The Guide provides an overview of more open tools for annotation and de-identification

Mini-experiment: Let’s take these steps

We created a mini experiment*

- We recorded a short audio fragment
- Script with various kinds of identifying information

A: Welcome Maaike, nice that you are here.

B: Nice to see you too Ricarda, happy to be here.

A: So what we want to do today is test the anonymisation tool Textwash or FAMTAFOS that was developed by Bennett Kleinberg and colleagues.

B: Yes, we want to try ourselves if we can de-identify all the identifying information in this little audiosegment we are recording. It will serve as a test in our workshop "Making Qualitative Data Reusable" that we will hold during the DCC Spring Training Days on May 23rd 2024.

A: Right so to already throw in some identifying details - right now it is Tuesday 23 April 2024 11:00.

*Full text script, data, description and results of our mini-experiment are available on Zenodo :)

We created a mini experiment*

- We recorded a short audio fragment
- Script with various kinds of identifying information

Not all recorders support all output formats!

A: Welcome Maaike, nice that you are here.

B: Nice to see you too Ricarda, happy to be here.

A: So what we want to do today is test the anonymisation tool Textwash or FAMTAFOS that was developed by Bennett Kleinberg and colleagues.

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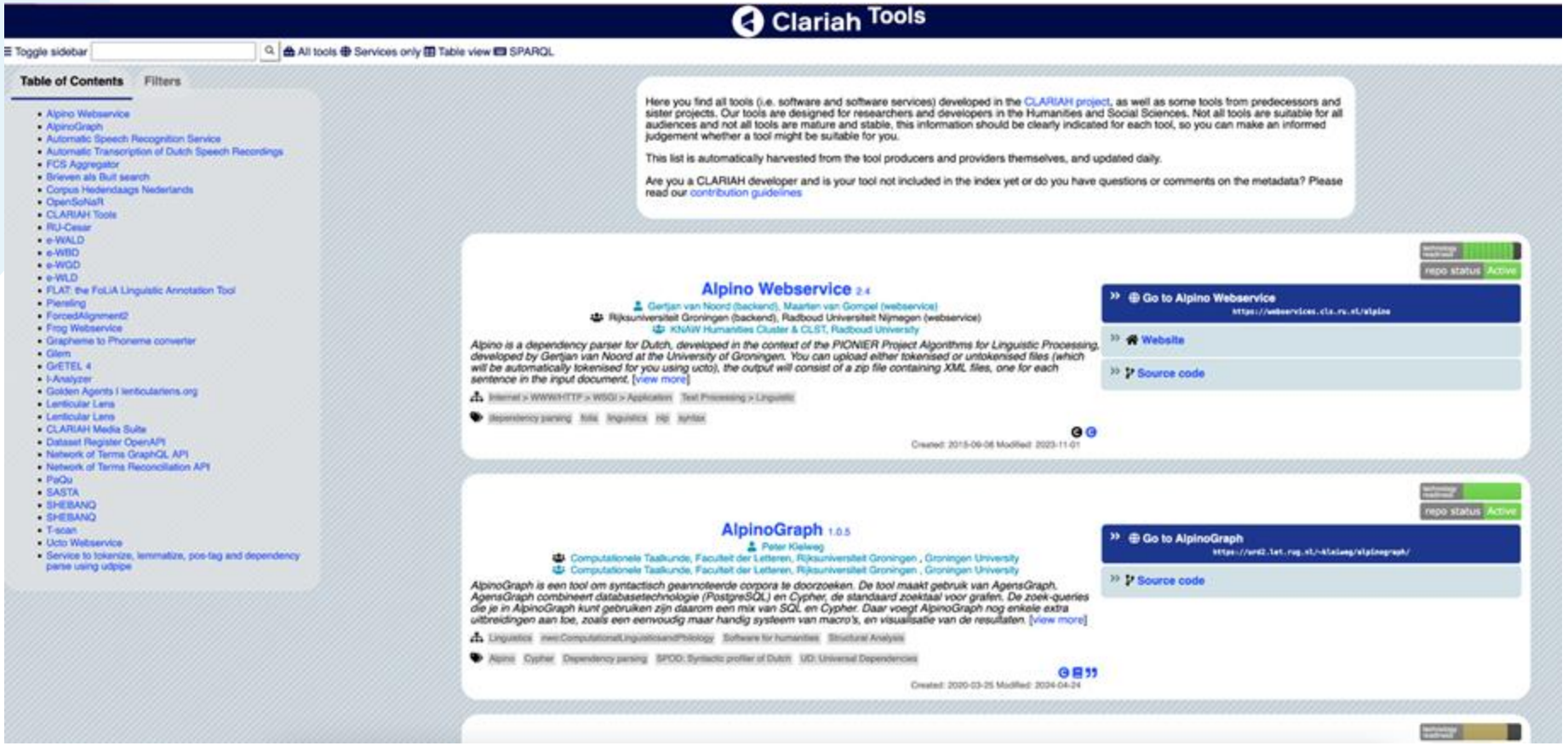
Step 1 From audio to text

- We searched in the CLARIAH Tools Registry

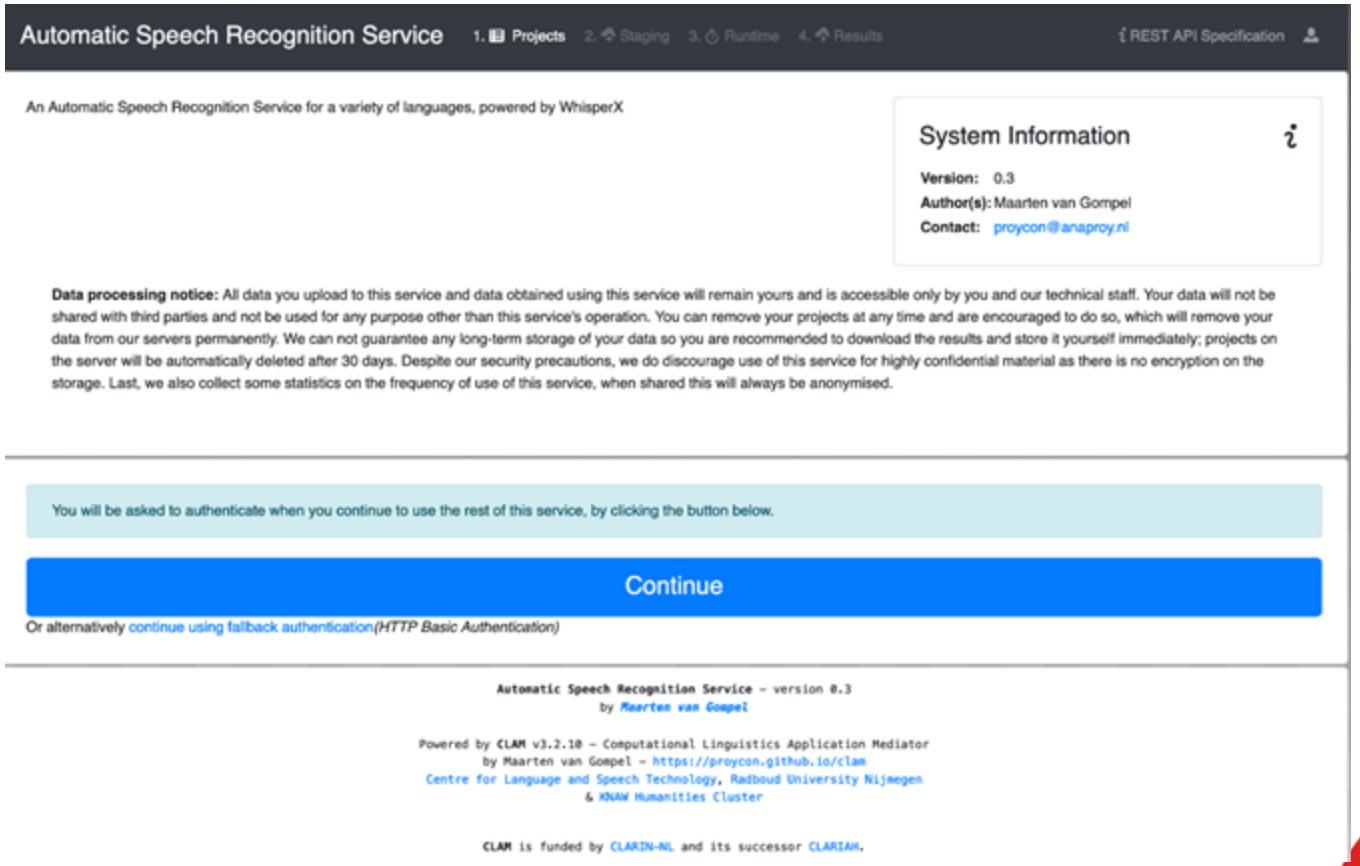


https://tools.clariah.nl/services/

Step 1 From audio to text - Results

- We found and tried out two tools
- Audio file formats can be an issue!
- Quality of the output varied
- Use for sensitive data?

→ Automatic Speech Recognition Service



https://github.com/opensource-spraakherkenning-nl/asrservice
https://tools.clariah.nl/asrservice/0.3/

Step 1 From audio to text - Resulting text file

A: Welcome Maaike, nice that you are here.

B: Nice to see you too Ricarda, happy to be here.

A: So what we want to do today is test the anonymisation tool Textwash or FAMTAFOS that was developed by Bennett Kleinberg and colleagues.

B: Yes, we want to try ourselves if we can de-identify all the identifying information in this little audiosegment we are recording. It will serve as a test in our workshop "Making Qualitative Data Reusable" that we will hold during the DCC Spring Training Days on May 23rd 2024.

A: Right so to already throw in some identifying details - right now it is Tuesday 23 April 2024 11:00.

```
Welcome, Maaike.
Nice that you're here.
Nice to see you, Ricarda.
Happy to be here.
So what we want to do today is test the anonymization tool Textwash or Fantafoss that was developed by Bennett, Kleinberg and colleagues.
Yes, we want to try ourselves if we can de-identify all the identifying information in this little audio segment that we are recording.
It will serve as a test in our workshop, making qualitative data reusable, that we will hold during the DCC Spring Training Days on May 23rd, 2024.
Right.
So to already throw in some identifying details, right now it is Tuesday, 23rd of April, 2024, 11 o'clock.
```

Step 2 - Deidentification of data

- To increase possibilities of data sharing and reuse
- **Anonymous** - data cannot be re-identified and is no longer considered personal/sensitive
- **Pseudonymised** - re-identification of the data remains possible (e.g., due to key that links person to data)

- Planning for data reuse
  - data minimisation
  - creating anonymisation pipeline
  - granular consent

Guides, tips & tricks: **FSD** | **UKDA** | **CESSDA** | **Erasmus University**

Step 2 De-identification - Textwash

- Textwash - Free automated multi-language text anonymization for open science
- Python based tool that replaces identifying information automatically

- At the time, difficult to run without help if you have limited time
  - We asked help from the author Bennett Kleinberg who ran the analysis for us (Thank you!!!)
  - However: they are constantly improving the Tool and its usability!

- Platform independent (runs on Python)

- Performs the de-identification for you

- Available models for English and Dutch

https://github.com/ben-aaron188/textwash

Step 2 De-identification - Textwash - Results

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B: Nice to see you too Ricarda, happy to be here.

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A: Right so to already throw in some identifying details - right now it is Tuesday 23 April 2024 11:00.

A: Welcome, PERSON_FIRSTNAME_2. Nice that you're here.

B: Nice to see you, PERSON_FIRSTNAME_3. Happy to be here.

A: So what we want to do today is test the anonymization tool OTHER_1 or OTHER_2 that was developed by PERSON_FIRSTNAME_1 PERSON_LASTNAME_1 and colleagues.

B: Yes, we want to try ourselves if we can de-identify all the identifying information in this little audio segment that we are recording. It will serve as a test in our workshop, making qualitative data reusable, that we will hold during the OTHER_3 OTHER_4 Training Days on DATE_1 DATE_2, NUMERIC_1.

A: Right. So to already throw in some identifying details, right now it is DATE_5, DATE_2 DATE_3 DATE_1, NUMERIC_1, TIME_1 o'clock.

DISCUSSION

DISCUSSION
10 min

Which tools are relevant for the data you work with?

How do you evaluate tools for certain needs (especially for sensitive data)?

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Planning a study with reuse in mind

Planning Your Project

- Create a Data Management Plan (DMP) with reusability in mind
- Prepare your Informed Consents form well to include data sharing
- Consider best practices on file and folder naming to manage your data

https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.8160880

Informed consent

- Not only for participation in the study, but also for the archiving and sharing of the data
  - Consider in advance what data sharing you want to facilitate!
    - Purposes or role of reuser
    - Which parts of the data for which use (granular consent)
    - Anonymisation

- Sensitive data → GDPR
  - Art. 7 > Conditions for Informed Consent
  - Ch. 3 > Rights of the data subject

- *You can obtain consent for sharing non-anonymised data, but it is still not always recommended to do so*

Art. 7 GDPR

Conditions for consent

1. Where processing is based on consent, the controller shall be able to demonstrate that the data subject has consented to processing of his or her personal data.
2. If the data subject's consent is given in the context of a written declaration which also concerns other matters, the request for consent shall be presented in a manner which is clearly distinguishable from the other matters, in an intelligible and easily accessible form, using clear and plain language. Any part of such a declaration which constitutes an infringement of this Regulation shall not be binding.
3. The data subject shall have the right to withdraw his or her consent at any time. The withdrawal of consent shall not affect the lawfulness of processing based on consent before its withdrawal. Prior to giving consent, the data subject shall be informed thereof. It shall be as easy to withdraw as to give consent.
4. When assessing whether consent is freely given, utmost account shall be taken of whether, *inter alia*, the performance of a contract, including the provision of a service, is conditional on consent to the processing of personal data that is not necessary for the performance of that contract.

Templates

THE QUALITATIVE ELECTION STUDY OF BRITAIN

THE WORLD'S FIRST LONGITUDINAL QUALITATIVE ELECTION STUDY

UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD

Written informed consent process (includir

Description	File download
Any relevant advertising or recruiting material (poster, email text, social media advert)	Template poster advert
Template information sheet	Participant information sheet template
Template written consent form	Written consent form template

Data Management Expert Guide

Click to see examples of consent forms

- UK Data Archive
- MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit - University of Cambridge
- FORS (Swiss Centre of Expertise in the Social Sciences)

TU Delft Delft University of Technology

TEMPLATE 1: Participant Information/Opening Statement

Key points to include

1. Level (eg: Masters, PhD, research) purpose, potential outcomes and implications of the study
2. The role of TU Delft and any third parties including funding body
3. Who participants are (eg: children, experts, students in a dependent role to the researcher)
4. What exactly what they are being asked to do
5. What if any Personal Data (Personally Identifiable Information and/or Personally Identifiable Research Data) will be collected, and how it will be used, published and managed. This should include clarity on:
   - how the data you collect will be used during the research
   - safeguarding personal information, maintaining confidentiality
   - de-identifying (pseudo/anonymising) data
   - controlling access to data, data archiving and reuse
   - (possible) data publication and dissemination, and
   - data archiving and the retention period for research data or criteria used to determine that
6. What physical, emotional or reputational risks might arise from participation either during or after the study, and what steps will be used to mitigate these risks
7. Participants' right to refuse to answer/withdraw from the study at any time
8. The right (or otherwise) of participants to request access to and rectify or erase personal data
9. Any remuneration for time/compensation for travel
10. Contact details of the Responsible Researcher and procedure for making complaints.

Note: the TU/D Human Research Ethics Committee should not be included as a contact and does not deal with participant complaints.

Examples and templates

Note that all examples below assume that they are preceded b

Template in Qualtrics | Examples CESSDA | Example sentences

Utrecht University

University of Oxford | CESSDA DMEG | Utrecht University (2) | TU Delft | QESB

DISCUSSION

DISCUSSION
10 min

Consider the example dataset(s) again:

What elements would have been needed in the informed consent form to publish the data in this way?

Q&A & Wrap Up

Contributors

Qualitative Data Guide

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Anna Volkova (EUR)
Kristi Winters (GESIS)

More questions?

Thank you for your attention

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LinkedIn @DANS

Please fill out the evaluation form